

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

The Criminal Trade In Ancient Objects

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 30

No.	Sentence
1	Purchased a Roman coin aged _____
2	Research revealed extensive illegal networks involving _____
3	Many historical items sold have been taken by force and _____
4	Objects created by humans with historical value, e.g. coins and _____
5	During _____, items were commonly removed from their places of origin
6	Relocated to _____ and museums in other countries
7	_____ has transformed the illegal trade
8	Previously, sellers needed to work with _____ to find buyers
9	This difficulty acted as a _____ in the process
10	Now communication between sellers and _____ is direct
11	Museums serve as the _____ destination for many stolen items
12	Several institutions, such as the Louvre in _____, face allegations
13	Accusations include purchasing stolen items either knowingly or _____
14	Victoria Reed works as _____ at the institution
15	In 2024, the museum returned a necklace taken illegally from _____
16	The theft occurred during the _____
17	Returning items to their _____ is called repatriation

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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18	Victoria Reed supports practice of _____
19	She also advocates for careful _____ decisions
20	Her position is considered not extreme and acceptable - a _____ stance

What attitude does the speaker Ryan Keane express towards the trade in ancient artefacts?

- A He is alarmed by the extent of criminal networks involved
- B He is doubtful about the authenticity of ancient objects
- C He is indifferent to how artefacts are sold online
- D He is excited about finding new collectors for artefacts

According to Neil, what is the main reason ancient artefacts are historically interesting?

- A They are objects crafted by humans long ago
- B They are valuable due to their material worth
- C They are made in famous museums worldwide
- D They are always linked to famous movie stories

What does the word "looted" most likely refer to in this context?

- A Objects stolen by force or illegal means
- B Items carefully excavated by archaeologists
- C Museums purchasing objects through legal channels
- D Artefacts displayed with full government approval

What does Amr Al-Azm mean by calling social media a "game changer" for illegal artefact sales?

- A Social media destroys the market for stolen items
- B Social media facilitates easy communication between sellers and buyers
- C Social media increases the difficulty of selling artefacts
- D Social media forces middlemen to act as barriers

What is the main problem that "bottleneck" describes in this programme?

- A It is the delay in returning artefacts to countries
- B It is the blockage that slows down seller-buyer contact
- C It is the shortage of ancient objects on the market
- D It is the museum's refusal to display looted artefacts

What role do museums play in the fight against illegal artefact trading?

- A They are the final destinations for most looted treasures
- B They sell stolen objects to private collectors
- C They ignore accusations related to illegal purchases
- D They avoid returning artefacts to original countries

How does Victoria Reed describe her approach to repatriation decisions?

- A She supports only returning artefacts upon strong evidence
- B She takes a moderate view, balancing responsibility and caution
- C She opposes repatriation completely to keep artefacts in museums
- D She believes repatriation should always happen immediately

What does the phrase "middle-of-the-road" mean in this discussion?

- A A position that is extreme and controversial
- B A balanced viewpoint acceptable to most people
- C A decision made without careful consideration
- D An opinion favored only by museum curators

What ongoing debate is mentioned regarding ancient artefacts?

- A Whether they should be preserved or destroyed over time
- B If objects should be returned to their origin or stay in museums
- C How to increase the sale of artefacts on social media
- D Whether ancient objects are authentic or modern fakes

Why is the discovery of the Mask of Tutankhamun considered important?

- A It is a famous ancient artefact found in Egypt in 1922
- B It was the first item stolen from the Valley of the Kings
- C It was originally kept in private collections abroad
- D It was used as a prop in popular adventure movies